Please note: The order of questions, as well as the order of options, was randomized for each student. Therefore, the sequence shown below may differ from the order you encountered during the quiz.

Question #: 1 (6 points)

Fill in the blank so that the following argument becomes valid. Note that the order of premises (i.e., which is premise 1 and which is premise 2) does not affect the validity of an argument.

Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

Premise 1. Different cultures have different moral codes.
Premise 2. [ ]
Conclusion. Cultural relativism is true.

✓A. If different cultures have different moral codes, cultural relativism is true.
B. If cultural relativism is true, different cultures have different moral codes.
C. If it is not the case that different cultures have different moral codes, it is not the case that cultural relativism is true.

Answer: A. No partial credits.

If we fill in the blank with A, we get the following argument, which has the (1), always valid form in the slide below:

Premise 1. Different cultures have different moral codes.
Premise 2. If different cultures have different moral codes, cultural relativism is true.
Conclusion. Cultural relativism is true.

(1) Always valid
If A, then B
A.
Therefore, B.

(2) Always valid
If A, then B
Not B.
Therefore, Not A.

(3) Always invalid
If A, then B
Not A.
Therefore, Not B.

(4) Always invalid
If A, then B
B.
Therefore, A.

If we fill in the blank with B, we get the following argument, which has the (4), always invalid form in the slide:

Premise 1. Different cultures have different moral codes.
Premise 2. If cultural relativism is true, different cultures have different moral codes.
Conclusion. Cultural relativism is true.

If we fill in the blank with C, we get the following argument, which has the (3), always invalid form in the slide (A= it is not the case that different cultures have different moral codes, B= it is not the case that cultural relativism is true):

Premise 1. Different cultures have different moral codes.
Premise 2. If it is not the case that different cultures have different moral codes, it is not the case that cultural relativism is true.
Conclusion. Cultural relativism is true.

Question #: 2 (6 points)

Is the following statement true or false?
An argument with all false premises and a false conclusion can still be valid.

✓A. True
B. False

Answer: A. See, for instance, the Taylor Swift argument in the slide below.

- A **sound** argument is a **valid** argument whose **premises are all true.**

  Soundness = (1) validity + (2) all premises being true.
  Both conditions need to be met for an argument to be sound.

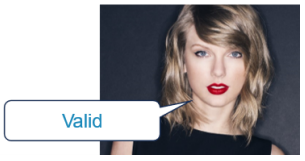
- A **valid** argument:

  Its premises and conclusion are connected in such a way that…
  if the premises are all true, the conclusion must be true as well
  In other words, the conclusion follows from the premises. The premises, if all true, 100% guarantee the truth of the conclusion.
  (It doesn't matter whether the premises are actually true.)

  How to check whether argument is valid:
  Assume that all the premises are true and think about whether it is possible for the conclusion to be false. If yes, invalid. If no, valid.

  E.g.) P1. All philosophers are men.
  P2. Taylor Swift is a philosopher.
  C. Taylor Swift is a man.

  Valid or invalid?



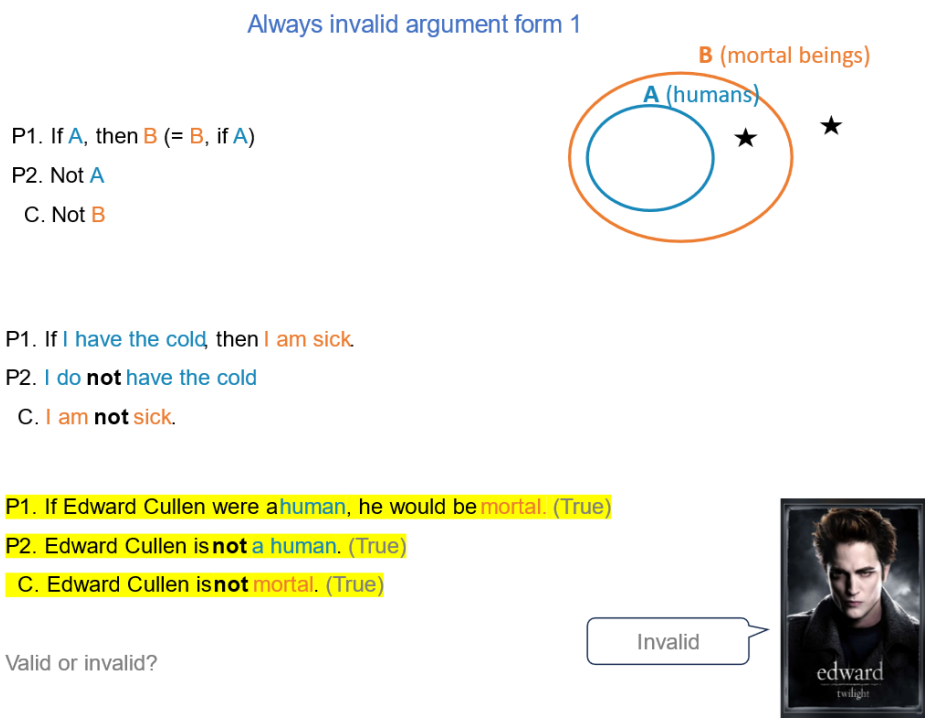
Question #: 3 (6 points)

Is the following statement true or false?

If an argument's premises and conclusion are all true, the argument is sound.

A. True
✓B. False

Answer: B
An argument with all true premises and a true conclusion can be unsound. See, for instance, the Edward Cullen argument in the slide below (an invalid argument is unsound).



Question #: 4 (5 points)

Is the following argument valid or invalid?

Premise 1. If it is raining, the streets are wet.
Premise 2. The streets are wet.
Conclusion. Therefore, it is raining.

A. Valid
✓B. Invalid

Answer: B
This argument has the (4), always invalid form in the slide on the first page (See Question 1)

Question #: 5 (6 points)

Which of the following is true according to cultural relativism?
Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

A. Every culture ought to be tolerant of other cultures.
B. It is impossible for a person to perform a morally wrong action within their own culture unless they leave their own culture to live elsewhere.
C. A member of one culture never has any moral obligations toward a member of another culture.
D. All of the above.
✓E. None of the above.

Answer: E. No partial credits.

A is false because, according to cultural relativism, there is no universal moral truth applicable to every culture. If a culture's moral codes dictate that they need not be tolerant of other cultures, then that belief is true within that culture.

B is false. Even under cultural relativism, a person can commit a morally wrong action within their culture if they violate that culture's moral codes.

C is false. Even if cultural relativism holds, a member of one culture may still have a moral obligation toward a member of another culture, if such an obligation is part of their own culture's moral codes.

Question #: 6 (6 points)

Is the following statement true or false? Assume that Thomson is right about what counts as killing.

If you don't need another person to achieve your aim (that is, if you can still achieve your aim even if the person disappears before you perform your action), then you're not killing the person.

A. True
✓B. False

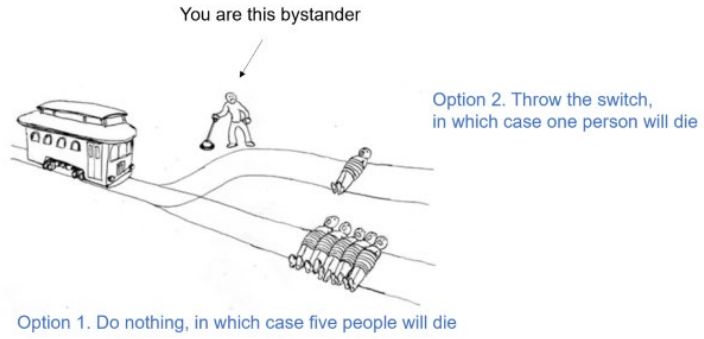
Answer: B.

It is not the case that whenever you don't need another person to achieve your aim, you're not killing them. Consider, for instance, throwing the switch in Bystander. You don't need the person on the sidetrack to achieve your aim of saving the five people (you can still save the five even if the person on the side track disappears before you throw the switch). But you're still killing the person, according to Thomson.

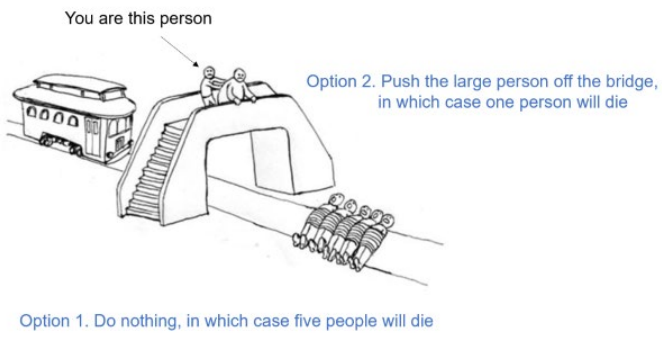
Question #: 7 (6 points)

Which of the following is true about Bystander and Bridge? The common intuition is that Option 2 is permissible in Bystander and not permissible in Bridge.
Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

< Bystander >



< Bridge>



✓A. Classic utilitarians think that there is no morally relevant difference between Bystander and Bridge.
B. According to Kant's theory (as interpreted by Moonyoung), Option 2 amounts to treating a person merely as a means in both Bystander and Bridge.
C. Foot's distinction between killing and letting die can easily explain why many people have the common intuition.
✓D. According to Thomson, Option 2 is killing in both Bystander and Bridge.
✓E. Both classic utilitarians and Thomson think that the common intuition is wrong.

Answer: A, D, E.

Partial credits are given as follows: 6 points - 2 points per incorrect choice, including not choosing a true option. For example, if you chose A, C, and D, you get 6–4=2 points because you made two incorrect choices (choosing C and not choosing E). If you chose A and D, you get 6–2=4 points because you made one incorrect choice (not choosing E).

A is true. For classic utilitarians, only the consequences of your action (= the number of people who will survive and die, in the trolley cases) morally matter, and there is no difference in the consequences between Bystander and Bridge.

B is false. Option 2 in Bystander doesn't even amount to treating a person as a means (because you can still achieve your aim of saving the five even if the person on the side track disappears). So, it doesn't amount to treating a person merely as a means, either.

C is false. Option 2 is killing in both Bridge and Bystander. So, the killing vs. letting die distinction cannot easily explain why many people think Option 2 is permissible only in Bystander.

D is true. And that's why Thomson thinks Option 2 is impermissible in both Bystander and

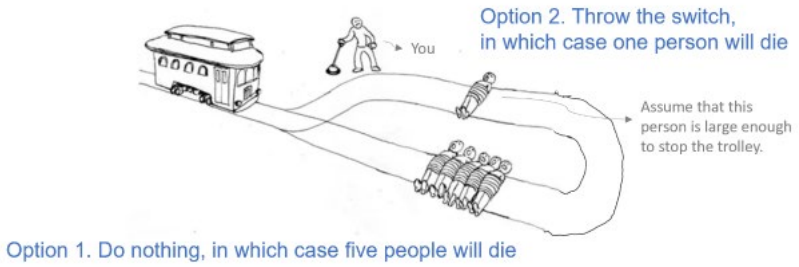
Bridge, given that Option 1 is letting die in both cases.

E is true. Classic utilitarians think that Option 2 is permissible in both Bystander and Bridge, and Thomson thinks that Option 2 is impermissible in both Bystander and Bridge.

Question #: 8 (6 points)

Which of the following is true about the Loop case?
Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

< Loop >



✓A. Given what she says in "Turning the Trolley", Thomson would probably say that it is morally wrong to throw the switch in Loop.
✓B. By throwing the switch to save the five people, you are treating the one person who will die as a means.
C. Classic utilitarians would probably say that it is morally wrong to throw the switch.
✓D. Given what Thomson says in "Turning the Trolley," Thomson and Foot would agree on what the right action is in Loop.

Answer: A, B, D. No partial credits.

A is true. In “Turning the Trolley”, Thomson argues that throwing the switch is morally wrong in Bystander. Given this, she would probably say that throwing the switch is morally wrong in Loop as well. In both cases, you have the alternative option to let five die (which is better than killing one according to Thomson). A difference between throwing the switch in Bystander and Loop is that, in Loop, you use the one person as a means (and possibly merely as a means). This, however, adds even more reason to think that throwing the switch is morally wrong in Loop.

B is true. If the person disappears right before you throw the switch, you won’t be able to achieve your aim of saving the five.

C is false. Classic utilitarians would probably say that it is morally permissible to throw the switch because it generates a better consequence.

D is true. In “Turning the Trolley”, Thomson defends Foot’s view. Given this, they would agree on what the right action is in Loop.

Question #: 9 (6 points)

Moonyoung already owns more than enough shoes, but she is considering purchasing a new pair for $100 purely for the mild pleasure it would give her (suppose she has no important need for that money elsewhere). However, as someone who teaches Peter Singer’s “Famine, Affluence, and Morality,” she feels conflicted. So, instead of buying the expensive pair, she chooses to spend $50 on a cheaper pair of shoes and donates the remaining $50 to a charity that effectively combats malaria in developing countries by providing insecticidal nets.

Suppose that if everyone in circumstances similar to Moonyoung’s donated $50 to the charity, there would be no suffering or death caused by malaria (although not everyone in such circumstances will, in fact, do so).

What would Singer say about Moonyoung’s action of spending $50 on new shoes and donating $50 to charity? Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

✓A. Moonyoung’s action is morally wrong.
B. Moonyoung’s action is supererogatory.
C. Moonyoung’s action is morally permissible.
D. Moonyoung’s action is morally required.
E. Moonyoung’s action is morally neutral.

Answer: A. No partial credits.

This question is the same as the first question in Practice Questions (Week 3), except for the added information (the highlighted part). However, this information does not change the moral wrongness of Moonyoung’s action. Please see what Singer says on p. 233 of the reading. (As I have announced multiple times, some quiz or exam questions may require knowledge from the readings that wasn't covered in class.)

Question #: 10 (6 points)

Below is one way to formulate Peter Singer's argument.

Premise 1. We ought to save the drowning child.
Premise 2. If we ought to save the drowning child, then we ought to help people who are dying and suffering from extreme poverty in developing countries.
Conclusion. We ought to help people who are dying and suffering from extreme poverty in developing countries.

Suppose a philosopher says the following in response to Singer's argument: "Whether a person is physically near to us or not makes a difference in whether we ought to help them or not." Which of the following is true? Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

A. This philosopher is denying Premise 1 of Singer's argument.
✓B. This philosopher is denying Premise 2 of Singer's argument.
C. This philosopher is claiming that Singer's argument is invalid.
✓D. This philosopher is claiming that Singer's argument is unsound.

Answer: B, D. No partial credits.

What the philosopher is saying is that, even if we ought to save the drowning child, it doesn't necessarily follow from this that we ought to help people who are dying and suffering from extreme poverty in developing countries (because there is a difference in physical distance between the two cases). As we discussed in class, Singer thinks that this difference in physical distance has no moral significance, but this philosopher thinks it has a moral significance. If this philosopher is right, P2 is false, and, thus, the argument is unsound. This philosopher's point doesn't affect P1 or the validity of the argument.

Question #: 11 (6 points)

Why is the slogan 'the greatest happiness for the greatest number' not entirely accurate in describing classic utilitarianism?
Assume that happiness and pleasure are the same.
Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

✓A. According to classic utilitarianism, not just the pleasure an action produces but also the pain it produces matters in determining whether the action is right or wrong.
✓B. According to classic utilitarianism, an action that benefits the greatest number of people may not always be the right action

C. According to classic utilitarianism, what matters in determining whether an action is right or wrong is the amount of pain, not pleasure, that the action produces.
D. According to classic utilitarianism, an action is either morally required or wrong.

Answer: A, B. No partial credits.

As I explained while going over the slide below in class, the slogan is not entirely accurate for two reasons, A and B.
C is false. D is not directly relevant to the slogan and, strictly speaking, is false as well, since multiple actions can produce the same, highest total net pleasure, in which case those actions are neither required nor wrong.

(Classic) Utilitarianism

- (Classic) Utilitarianism: a right action is an action that maximizes the good, with the good understood according to hedonism.
  → a right action is an action that maximizes total net pleasure or happiness

  total net pleasure = total pleasure the action produces to everyone affected by the action – total pain the action produces to everyone affected by the action

- "the greatest (net) happinessfor the greatest number"?

  There are 10 people affected by your action

  Action1: each person experiences 1 unit of pleasure (and no pain) = 10 units of pleasure

  Action2: only one person experiences pleasure, but it is 50 units (and no one experiences pain) = 50 units of pleasure

  → Action2 is the right action.

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Question #: 12 (6 points)

You have two available actions to choose from, with no other options. Below is the full information about how much pleasure and pain each action will generate. The actions will not generate any additional pleasure or pain beyond what is described.

Action A will generate 2 units of pleasure (and no pain) for a cat.
Action B will generate 1 unit of pleasure (and no pain) for a human being.

Which action is the right action, according to classic utilitarianism? Assume that a unit of pleasure is of the same amount and quality, regardless of which species experiences it.

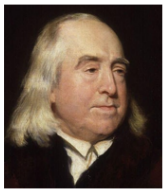
✓A. Action A
B. Action B
C. Both actions are right
D. Both actions are wrong

Answer: A

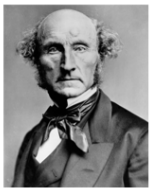
As the slide below indicates, on classic utilitarianism, any being's pleasure matters equally, *if it is of the same amount and quality* (note the question makes it clear that this condition is satisfied). So, Action A maximizes total net pleasure and, thus, is the right action.
In reality, it is possible that the same-amount-and-quality condition is not satisfied (because animals arguably cannot feel "higher" kinds of pleasure such as intellectual pleasure).

Classic utilitarianism is **impartial**.

Anyone's pleasure (or pain) matters equally, *if it is of the same amount and quality* , regardless of their class, gender, race, nationality... (and species)



Jeremy Bentham
(1748-1832)



John Stuart Mill
(1806-1873)

Women are equal to men!

Slavery should be abolished!

Animals morally matter, too!

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Question #: 13 (6 points)

Suppose that an action generates 10 units of pleasure and 10 units of pain in total. Which of the following is true about the moral status of this action according to classic utilitarianism?
Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

A. The action is morally permissible.
B. The action is morally required.
C. The action is morally wrong.
D. The action is morally neutral.
✓E. We need more information to determine the moral status of this action.

Answer: E. No partial credits.

According to classic utilitarianism, a right action is an action that maximizes total net pleasure among the available actions in the given context. Since we don't know what the other available actions are, we cannot determine the moral status of this action. If the other available actions all produce less total net pleasure than 0 (i.e., if they produce more pain than pleasure), this action would be right. If there is an available action that produces more total net pleasure than 0, this action would be wrong.

Also see the explanation for the third question in Practice Question (Week3), which is about the same point.

Question #: 14 (6 points)

Which of the following is true about the following argument?

Select all correct answers (there may or may not be more than one correct answer, and there is at least one correct answer).

Premise 1. If taking a philosophy course is morally permissible, then taking a philosophy course is morally required.
Premise 2. Taking a philosophy course is not morally required.
Conclusion. Taking a philosophy course is not morally permissible.

✓A. The argument is valid.
B. The argument is invalid.
C. The argument is sound.
✓D. The argument is unsound.
E. None of the above.

Answer: A, D.

Partial credits are given as follows: 6 points - 3 points per incorrect choice, including not

choosing a true option. For example, if you chose A, you get 6–3=3 points because you made one incorrect choice (not choosing D). An exception: Those who chose A and C won't be penalized for choosing C and will get 3 points.

A is true. The argument has the (2), always valid form in the slide on the first page (Question 1).

B is false. The argument is valid.

C is false. The argument is unsound.

D is true because P1 is false. The set of morally permissible actions is not a subset of the set of morally required actions; rather, the set of morally required actions is a subset of the set of morally permissible actions.

Question #: 15 (6 points)

Anna wants only pleasure and nothing else, and she decides to spend her entire life in the experience machine. Three philosophers are discussing Anna's decision.

Philosopher A: Anna made the right decision. In fact, that decision is the right decision for everyone else.
Philosopher B: Anna didn't make the right decision.
Philosopher C: I agree with Philosopher A that Anna made the right decision, but I think the decision isn't the right one for many other people.

"The right decision" means the decision that makes the person's life most valuable. Assume also that life in the experience machine provides more net pleasure than life in reality for everyone.

What theory does each of these philosophers most likely endorse (they all endorse different theories)?

Answer:

Philosopher A: <u>Hedonism</u>
Philosopher B: <u>Objective List Theory</u>
Philosopher C: <u>Desire Theory</u>

Partial credits are given (2 points per each philosopher)

Philosopher A is likely a hedonist because they think everyone's life would be more valuable if they plugged into the experience machine. This is true on hedonism, assuming, as written in the question, that life in the experience machine provides more net pleasure than life in reality for everyone.

Philosopher B likely endorses an objective list theory, according to which there are things that are objectively valuable for a person, regardless of whether they want them or not. On this view, spending one's entire life in the experience machine is unlikely to be the right decision, even if the person only wants pleasure.

Philosopher C is likely a desire theorist. In the case of Anna, spending her entire life in the experience machine is the right decision because she only desires pleasure, and she'll get more pleasure in the experience machine. But most people have other desires that cannot be fulfilled in the experience machine, so plugging into the experience machine wouldn't be the right choice for many of them on the desire theory.

Question #: 16 (6 points)

Is the following statement true or false?

On the desire theory, it is possible that a person doesn't know how valuable their life is.

✓A. True
B. False

Answer: A.

As we discussed in class, using the example of a mother who desires her missing child's safety but doesn't know whether the child is safe, sometimes a person may not know whether their desires are fulfilled. On the desire theory, in such a case, the person doesn't know how valuable their life is.

Question #: 17 (5 points)

Which of the following most accurately represents Nozick's conclusion from the experience machine thought experiment?

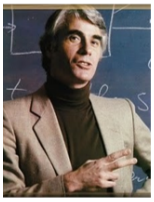
A. Pleasure is only instrumentally valuable.
B. Pleasure is only non-instrumentally valuable.
C. Pleasure is more valuable than other things.
D. Pleasure is not the only thing that is instrumentally valuable.
✓E. Pleasure is not the only thing that is non-instrumentally valuable

Answer: E

See the slide below.

The Experience Machine

- Nozick's points seem to be as follows.
  - Most people would not plug into the experience machine for life, even though they would have more pleasure that way.
  - This counts against hedonism because if hedonism is true, which means pleasure is the only thing that is non-instrumentally good, there is no reason not to plug into the experience machine.
  - Our hesitation suggests that we think there are other things than pleasure that are non-instrumentally good.



Robert Nozick
(1938 – 2002)

"We learn that something matters to us in addition to experience by imagining an experience machine and then realizing that we would not use it." (p.265)

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